



A symbol of sustainability and an excellent partnership: Evonik's tree-planting campaign

Evonik Industries' high-performance polymers ensure resource efficiency and sustainable production in a wide array of applications. They make vehicles lighter, gas pipes more durable, and solar modules flexible. All of this is only possible thanks to the close collaboration with numerous partners and customers. Evonik has kicked off a tree-planting initiative in order to make this way of thinking visible.

Evonik's High Performance Polymers Business Line has planted 31 trees in the vicinity of Sendenhorst in North-Rhine Westphalia, Germany. Each single tree is dedicated to one of the many partners who make the broad-scale spectrum of resource-friendly plastics applications become reality in cooperation with Evonik.

"For us, every one of the trees has a double meaning," said Markus Hartmann, Senior Business Manager of the Energy Supply department. "On the one hand, it stands for the sustainability and efficiency we've already achieved with our products, and which we aim to achieve further. And on the other hand, the trees symbolize the excellent relationship with our customers and partners." Thomas Grosse-Puppenthal, Vice President of the Resource Efficiency growth line, added: "Relationships with our partners will continue to grow and form ever stronger roots just like these trees. Of course, we hope many more trees will sprout up, too."

Among others, Evonik's high-performance polymers include the VESTAMID® NRG and VESTAMID® Terra brands. Designed especially for the oil and gas market, VESTAMID® NRG makes the transportation and extraction of fossil energy fuels efficient and secure. In contrast, VESTAMID® Terra is based on renewable raw materials. With a bio content of up to 100%, it is deployable in a wide variety of technologically challenging applications—and in the process, it enhances the CO₂ balance during production.

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Caption:

31 trees for 31 partners: they're still saplings, but they will flourish into a small forest in just a few years.



Company information

Evonik, the creative industrial group from Germany, is one of the world leaders in specialty chemicals. Profitable growth and a sustained increase in the value of the company form the heart of Evonik's corporate strategy. Its activities focus on the key megatrends health, nutrition, resource efficiency and globalization. Evonik benefits specifically from its innovative prowess and integrated technology platforms.

Evonik is active in over 100 countries around the world. In fiscal year 2011, more than 33,000 employees generated sales of around €14.5 billion and an operating profit (adjusted EBITDA) of about €2.8 billion.

Disclaimer

Insofar as forecasts or expectations are expressed in this press release or where our statements concern the future, these forecasts, expectations or statements may involve known or unknown risks and uncertainties. Actual results or developments may vary, depending on changes in the operating environment. Neither Evonik Industries AG nor its group companies assume an obligation to update the forecasts, expectations or statements contained in this release.

Customize this letter to your purpose - it could be a letter to your Member of Provincial Parliament, Member of Parliament, city council, local workforce development initiative, family network, etc.

YOUR NAME

Your Address

Your email/phone

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DATE

I am writing to request a meeting to discuss an important equity and access issue with you. [customize to your ask]

Young people with disabilities often finish high school with limited or no work experience. This makes it very difficult for them to find employment.¹ The latest Statistics Canada data shows a gap of at least 16% in the employment rate of individuals with disabilities (closer to 50% for those with more significant disabilities).²

One of the major reasons it is so hard for youth to get work experience is that there is no public funding for “start early” employment training programs or employment support services while youth are in school.^{3,4}

We know that supported employment services are effective in connecting individuals with disabilities to the workforce and employers to vital human resources.^{5,6} Why are these services only available when youth with disabilities graduate? By that milestone, they are years behind peers and experience long-term “career scarring” and impacts to overall health and wellbeing.⁷

Our community has [or wants to start] a highly effective “start early” employment training program called Project SEARCH. Our program is at risk [cannot start] because of the public funding gap.

A recent study showed that with a small public investment of \$16-17,000 per person for “start early” employment programming, government would realize a 600% return (\$127,000+) per person.^{3,4}

Employment is a social determinant of health and a human right.^{8,9} We need to find a way to get young people with disabilities the support they need to get the best start in life. This may require collaboration between education, labour, children’s services and health.

I look forward to discussing what our community can do to raise awareness of this important issue.

Signature

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Endnotes:

¹–Mazzotti, V. L., Rowe, D. A., Kwiatek, S., Voggt, A., Chang, W. H., Fowler, C. H., Poppen, M., Sinclair, J., & Test, D. W. (2021). Secondary transition predictors of postschool success: An update to the research base. *Career Development and Transition for Exceptional Individuals*, 44(1), 47-64.

²–Accessibility in Canada: Results from the 2022 Canadian Survey on Disability (2024-05-28). Retrieved from <https://www150.statcan.gc.ca/n1/daily-quotidien/240528/dq240528b-eng.htm>

³–Bowman, L. R., McDougall, C., Doucet, R., Pooran, B., Xu, Y., & Campbell, J. (2024). Funding employment inclusion for Ontario youth with disabilities: a theoretical cost-benefit model. *Frontiers in Sociology*, 9, 1281088.

⁴–Bowman, L. R., McDougall, C., Doucet, R., Pooran, B., & Campbell, J. (2024). Funding Employment Inclusion for Ontario Youth with Disabilities: A Cost-Benefit Model Update. https://hollandbloorview.ca/sites/default/files/2024-09/Funding-Employment-Inclusion-2024_0.pdf

⁵–Jetha, A., Shamaee, A., Tompa, E., Smith, P., Bültmann, U., Bonaccio, S., Tucker, L. B., Norman, C., Banks, C. G., & Gignac, M. A. (2023). The future of work in shaping the employment inclusion of young adults with disabilities: a qualitative study. *Equality, Diversity and Inclusion: An International Journal*, 42(9), 75-91.

⁶–Canadian Association for Supported Employment. (n.d.) About Supported Employment. Retrieved from <https://www.supportedemployment.ca/about/about-supported-employment/>

⁷–Krahn, H., & Chow, A. (2016). Youth unemployment and career scarring: Social-psychological mediating effects? *Canadian Journal of Sociology*, 41(2), 117-138.

⁸–Nations, U. (2006). Convention on the Rights Persons with Disabilities. Geneva Retrieved from <https://www.un.org/development/desa/disabilities/convention-on-the-rights-of-persons-with-disabilities/convention-on-the-rights-of-persons-with-disabilities-2.html>

⁹–Government of Canada. (2024). Sustainable Development Goal 8: Decent work and economic growth. Retrieved from: <https://www.canada.ca/en/employment-social-development/programs/agenda-2030/economic-growth.html>

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